



Sure Access to Success

DIRECT – INDIRECT SPEECH RULES

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DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH



Direct Speech

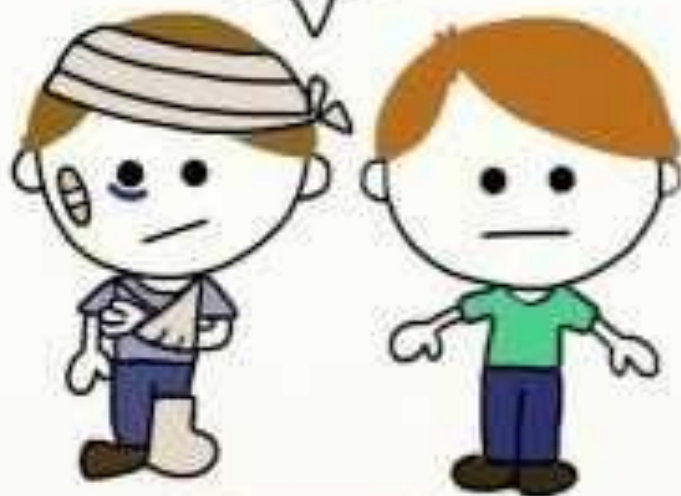


Indirect Speech



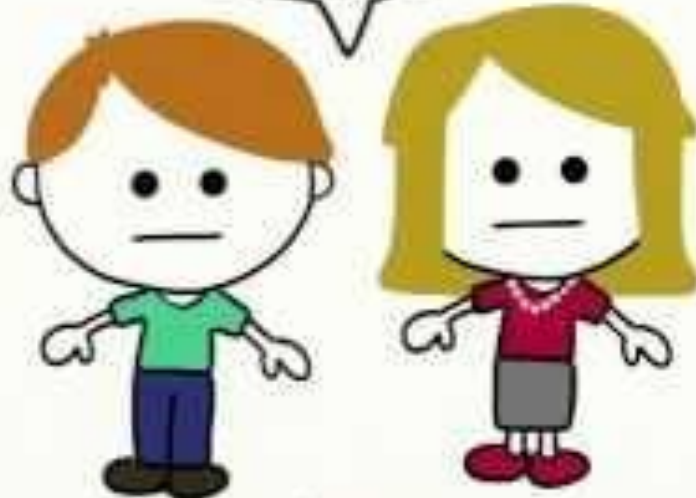
I FELL
DOWN THE
STAIRS.

PAST
TENSE



Saturday night

HE SAID THAT
HE HAD FALLEN
DOWN THE
STAIRS.



Sunday

There are two ways in which the words of a speaker can be reported:

Direct Speech/Direct Narration

We may quote the actual words used by the speaker.

John said, “I am going home.”

There are two ways in which the words of a speaker can be reported:

Indirect Speech/Indirect Narration

We may have the **substance of the words** used by the speaker and not his actual words.

John said that he was going home.

Vs.

John said, “I am going home.”

Direct Speech/Direct Narration

- Riya said, 'Sir, how do you feel now?'
- Riya asked me how I felt (then).
- Riya enquired how I felt (then).

John said, 'Smitha, get out!'

John **ordered** Smitha to get out.

John said, 'Smitha, please go out.'

John **asked** Smitha to go out.

Rule - 1

If the reporting verb (first part) of the sentence is in **present** or **future tense**, the tense of the reported speech is **not changed** while converting direct speech into indirect speech.

Example.

Direct speech: He says, "Sara **is** going to school".

Indirect speech: He says that Sara **is** going to school. (Tense not changed)

- He **will say**, 'I am ill.'
- He **will say** that he is ill.

Rule - 2

If the reporting verb (first part) of the sentence is in **past tense**, the tense of the reported speech **is changed** for converting direct speech into indirect speech.

Example.

Direct speech: He said, "Sara **is** going to school".

Indirect speech: He said that Sara **was** going to school. (Tense changed)

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT SIMPLE changes into PAST SIMPLE	
He said, "I write novels."	He said that he wrote novels.
She said, "I teach kids".	She said that she taught kids.
They said, "We play football".	They said that they played football.
You said, "I eat an apple".	

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT SIMPLE changes into PAST SIMPLE	
He said, "I write novels."	He said that he wrote novels.
She said, "I teach kids".	She said that she taught kids.
They said, "We play football".	They said that they played football.
You said, "I eat an apple".	You said that you ate an apple.
She said, "I work in a hospital".	

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT SIMPLE changes into PAST SIMPLE	
He said, "I write novels."	He said that he wrote novels.
She said, "I teach kids".	She said that she taught kids.
They said, "We play football".	They said that they played football.
You said, "I eat an apple".	You said that you ate an apple.
She said, "I work in a hospital".	She said that she worked in a hospital.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT SIMPLE changes into PAST SIMPLE	
He said, "I write novels."	He said that he wrote novels.
She said, "I teach kids".	She said that she taught kids.
They said, "We play football".	They said that they played football.
You said, "I eat an apple".	You said that you ate an apple.
She said, "I work in a hospital".	She said that she worked in a hospital.
	He said he did not like coffee.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT SIMPLE changes into PAST SIMPLE	
He said, "I write novels."	He said that he wrote novels.
She said, "I teach kids".	She said that she taught kids.
They said, "We play football".	They said that they played football.
You said, "I eat an apple".	You said that you ate an apple.
She said, "I work in a hospital".	She said that she worked in a hospital.
He said, "I do not like coffee".	He said he did not like coffee.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech		Indirect Speech	
PRESENT TENSE			
PRESENT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST CONTINUOUS			
He said, "I am waiting for a bus".		He said that he was waiting for a bus.	
She said, "I am drinking water".		She said that he was drinking water.	
They said, "We are decorating the room".		They said that they were decorating the room.	
He said, "I am enjoying the music".			

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I am waiting for a bus".	He said that he was waiting for a bus.
She said, "I am drinking water".	She said that he was drinking water.
They said, "We are decorating the room".	They said that they were decorating the room.
He said, "I am enjoying the music".	He said that he was enjoying the music.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I am waiting for a bus".	He said that he was waiting for a bus.
She said, "I am drinking water".	She said that he was drinking water.
They said, "We are decorating the room".	They said that they were decorating the room.
He said, "I am enjoying the music".	He said that he was enjoying the music.
You said, " David is driving a car".	

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I am waiting for a bus".	He said that he was waiting for a bus.
She said, "I am drinking water".	She said that he was drinking water.
They said, "We are decorating the room".	They said that they were decorating the room.
He said, "I am enjoying the music".	He said that he was enjoying the music.
You said, " David is driving a car".	You said that David was driving a car.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I am waiting for a bus".	He said that he was waiting for a bus.
She said, "I am drinking water".	She said that he was drinking water.
They said, "We are decorating the room".	They said that they were decorating the room.
He said, "I am enjoying the music".	He said that he was enjoying the music.
You said, " David is driving a car".	You said that David was driving a car.
	He said that he was not going to college.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I am waiting for a bus".	He said that he was waiting for a bus.
She said, "I am drinking water".	She said that [★] he was drinking water.
They said, "We are decorating the room".	They said that they were decorating the room.
He said, "I am enjoying the music".	He said that he was enjoying the music.
You said, "David is driving a car".	You said that David was driving a car.
He said, "I am not going to college".	He said that he was not going to college.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PRESENT TENSE

PRESENT PERFECT **changes into** PAST PERFECT

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT changes into PAST PERFECT	
She said, "I have bought a camera".	She said that she had bought a camera.
He said, "I have finished the work".	He said that he had finished the work.
They said, "We have spent all the money".	They said that they had spent all the money.
You said, "David has passed the exam".	
They said, "We have started a business".	

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT changes into PAST PERFECT	
She said, "I have bought a camera".	She said that she had bought a camera.
He said, "I have finished the work".	He said that he had finished the work.
They said, "We have spent all the money".	They said that they had spent all the money.
You said, "David has passed the exam".	You said that David had passed the exam.
They said, "We have started a business".	

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT changes into PAST PERFECT	
She said, "I have bought a camera".	She said that she had bought a camera.
He said, "I have finished the work".	He said that he had finished the work.
They said, "We have spent all the money".	They said that they had spent all the money.
You said, "David has passed the exam".	You said that David had passed the exam.
They said, "We have started a business".	They said that they had started a business.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT changes into PAST PERFECT	
She said, "I have bought a camera".	She said that she had bought a camera.
He said, "I have finished the work".	He said that he had finished the work.
They said, "We have spent all the money".	They said that they had spent all the money.
You said, "David has passed the exam".	You said that David had passed the exam.
They said, "We have started a business".	They said that they had started a business.
	He said that he had not received the letter.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT changes into PAST PERFECT	
She said, "I have bought a camera".	She said that she had bought a camera.
He said, "I have finished the work".	He said that he had finished the work.
They said, "We have spent all the money".	They said that they had spent all the money.
You said, "David has passed the exam".	You said that David had passed the exam.
They said, "We have started a business".	They said that they had started a business.
He said, "I have not received the letter".	He said that he had not received the letter.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PRESENT TENSE

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS **changes into** PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I have been living in London since 2018".	He said that he had been living in London since 2018.
She said, "I have been teaching students for five years".	She said that she had been teaching students for five years.
They said, "We have been working in a factory for three years".	They said that they had been working in a factory for five years.
The engineer said, "I have been repairing a machine since 10 AM".	
	He said that the patient had not been taking medicine for three days.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I have been living in London since 2018".	He said that he had been living in London since 2018.
She said, "I have been teaching students for five years".	She said that she had been teaching students for five years.
They said, "We have been working in a factory for three years".	They said that they had been working in a factory for five years.
The engineer said, "I have been repairing a machine since 10 AM".	The engineer said that he had been repairing a machine since 10 AM.
You said, "It has been raining for three hours".	

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I have been living in London since 2018".	He said that he had been living in London since 2018.
She said, "I have been teaching students for five years".	She said that she had been teaching students for five years.
They said, "We have been working in a factory for three years".	They said that they had been working in a factory for five years.
The engineer said, "I have been repairing a machine since 10 AM".	The engineer said that he had been repairing a machine since 10 AM.
You said, "It has been raining for three hours".	You said that it had been raining for three hours.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I have been living in London since 2018".	He said that he had been living in London since 2018.
She said, "I have been teaching students for five years".	She said that she had been teaching students for five years.
They said, "We have been working in a factory for three years".	They said that they had been working in a factory for five years.
The engineer said, "I have been repairing a machine since 10 AM".	The engineer said that he had been repairing a machine since 10 AM.
You said, "It has been raining for three hours".	You said that it had been raining for three hours.
	He said that the patient had not been taking medicine for three days.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
PRESENT TENSE	
PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS changes into PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS	
He said, "I have been living in London since 2018".	He said that he had been living in London since 2018.
She said, "I have been teaching students for five years".	She said that she had been teaching students for five years.
They said, "We have been working in a factory for three years".	They said that they had been working in a factory for five years.
The engineer said, "I have been repairing a machine since 10 AM".	The engineer said that he had been repairing a machine since 10 AM.
You said, "It has been raining for three hours".	You said that it had been raining for three hours.
He said, "The patient has not been taking medicine for three days".	He said that the patient had not been taking medicine for three days.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST SIMPLE changes into **PAST PERFECT**

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST SIMPLE **changes into** PAST PERFECT

He said, "I **saw** a joker"

He said that he **had seen** a joker.

She said, "I **broke** the glass".

She said that she **had broken** the glass.

They said, "We **won** a prize".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST SIMPLE **changes into** PAST PERFECT

He said, "I **saw** a joker"

He said that he **had seen** a joker.

She said, "I **broke** the glass".

She said that she **had broken** the glass.

They said, "We **won** a prize".

They said that they **had won** a prize.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST SIMPLE **changes into** PAST PERFECT

He said, "I **saw** a joker"

He said that he **had seen** a joker.

She said, "I **broke** the glass".

She said that she **had broken** the glass.

They said, "We **won** a prize".

They said that they **had won** a prize.

You said, "I **bought** a car".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST SIMPLE **changes into** PAST PERFECT

He said, "I **saw** a joker"

He said that he **had seen** a joker.

She said, "I **broke** the glass".

She said that she **had broken** the glass.

They said, "We **won** a prize".

They said that they **had won** a prize.

You said, "I **bought** a car".

You said that you **had bought** a car.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST SIMPLE **changes into** PAST PERFECT

He said, "I **saw** a joker"

He said that he **had seen** a joker.

She said, "I **broke** the glass".

She said that she **had broken** the glass.

They said, "We **won** a prize".

They said that they **had won** a prize.

You said, "I **bought** a car".

You said that you **had bought** a car.

He said that he **had not enjoyed** the party.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST SIMPLE **changes into** PAST PERFECT

He said, "I **saw** a joker"

He said that he **had seen** a joker.

She said, "I **broke** the glass".

She said that she **had broken** the glass.

They said, "We **won** a prize".

They said that they **had won** a prize.

You said, "I **bought** a car".

You said that you **had bought** a car.

He said, "I **did not enjoy** the party".

He said that he **had not enjoyed** the party.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST CONTINUOUS changes into PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST CONTINUOUS changes into PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

He said, "I **was** writing a story".

He said that he **had been** writing a story.

She said, "I **was** washing the shirts".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST CONTINUOUS **changes into** PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

He said, "I **was** writing a story".

He said that he **had been** writing a story.

She said, "I **was** washing the shirts".

She said that she **had been** washing the shirts.

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Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST CONTINUOUS **changes into** PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

He said, "I **was** writing a story".

He said that he **had been** writing a story.

She said, "I **was** washing the shirts".

She said that she **had been** washing the shirts.

They said, "We **were** watching a movie".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST CONTINUOUS **changes into** PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

He said, "I **was** writing a story".

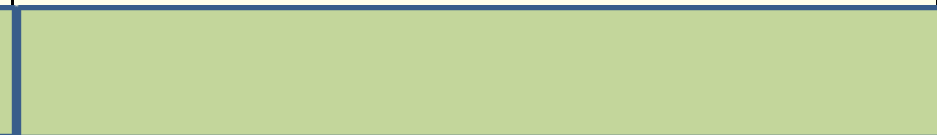
He said that he **had been** writing a story.

She said, "I **was** washing the shirts".

She said that she **had been** washing the shirts.

They said, "We **were** watching a movie".

They said that they **had been** watching a movie.



Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST CONTINUOUS **changes into** PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

He said, "I **was** writing a story".

He said that he **had been** writing a story.

She said, "I **was** washing the shirts".

She said that she **had been** washing the shirts.

They said, "We **were** watching a movie".

They said that they **had been** watching a movie.

She said that she **had not been** making a noise.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST CONTINUOUS **changes into** PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

He said, "I **was** writing a story".

He said that he **had been** writing a story.

She said, "I **was** washing the shirts".

She said that she **had been** washing the shirts.

They said, "We **were** watching a movie".

They said that they **had been** watching a movie.

She said, "I **was not** making a noise".

She said that she **had not been** making a noise.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT remains the same.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT remains the same.

He said, "I **had** resolved the issue".

He said that he **had** resolved the issue.

She said, "I **had** completed the task".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT remains the same.

He said, "I **had** resolved the issue".

He said that he **had** resolved the issue.

She said, "I **had** completed the task".

She said that she **had** completed the task.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT remains the same.

He said, "I **had** resolved the issue".

He said that he **had** resolved the issue.

She said, "I **had** completed the task".

She said that she **had** completed the task.

David said, "I **had** gone to school".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT remains the same.

He said, "I **had** resolved the issue".

He said that he **had** resolved the issue.

She said, "I **had** completed the task".

She said that she **had** completed the task.

David said, "I **had** gone to school".

David said that he **had** gone to school.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT remains the same.

He said, "I **had** resolved the issue".

He said that he **had** resolved the issue.

She said, "I **had** completed the task".

She said that she **had** completed the task.

David said, "I **had** gone to school".

David said that he **had** gone to school.

She said that she **had not** received the letter.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT remains the same.

He said, "I **had** resolved the issue".

He said that he **had** resolved the issue.

She said, "I **had** completed the task".

She said that she **had** completed the task.

David said, "I **had** gone to school".

David said that he **had** gone to school.

She said, "I **had not** received the letter.

She said that she **had not** received the letter.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS remains the same.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS remains the same.

He said, "I **had been** using the same car since 2005.

He said that he **had been** using the same car since 2005.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS remains the same.

He said, "I **had been** using the same car since 2005.

He said that he **had been** using the same car since 2005.

She said, "I **had been** reading a book since 10 AM".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS remains the same.

He said, "I **had been** using the same car since 2005.

He said that he **had been** using the same car since 2005.

She said, "I **had been** reading a book since 10 AM".

She said that she **had been** reading a book since 10 AM.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS *remains the same.*

He said, "I **had been** using the same car since 2005.

He said that he **had been** using the same car since 2005.

She said, "I **had been** reading a book since 10 AM".

She said that she **had been** reading a book since 10 AM.

They said that they **had been** helping poor people for three years.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

PAST TENSE

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS remains the same.

He said, "I **had been** using the same car since 2005.

He said that he **had been** using the same car since 2005.

She said, "I **had been** reading a book since 10 AM".

She said that she **had been** reading a book since 10 AM.

They said, "We **had been** helping poor people for three years.

They said that they **had been** helping poor people for three years.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE SIMPLE: will changes into would be

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE SIMPLE: will changes into would be

He said, "I **will** buy a camera".

He said that he **would** buy a camera.

He said, "I **will** go to London".

He said that he **would** go to London.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE SIMPLE: will changes into would be

He said, "I **will** buy a camera".

He said that he **would** buy a camera.

He said, "I **will** go to London".

He said that he **would** go to London.

She said, "I **will** wear a new dress".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE SIMPLE: will changes into would be

He said, "I **will** buy a camera".

He said that he **would** buy a camera.

He said, "I **will** go to London".

He said that he **would** go to London.

She said, "I **will** wear a new dress".

She said that she **would** wear a new dress.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE SIMPLE: will changes into would be

He said, "I **will** buy a camera".

He said that he **would** buy a camera.

He said, "I **will** go to London".

He said that he **would** go to London.

She said, "I **will** wear a new dress".

She said that she **would** wear a new dress.

They said, "We **will** celebrate the birthday of our son".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE SIMPLE: will changes into would be

He said, "I **will** buy a camera".

He said that he **would** buy a camera.

He said, "I **will** go to London".

He said that he **would** go to London.

She said, "I **will** wear a new dress".

She said that she **would** wear a new dress.

They said, "We **will** celebrate the birthday of our son".

They said that they **would** celebrate the birthday of their son.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE SIMPLE: will changes into would be

He said, "I **will** buy a camera".

He said that he **would** buy a camera.

He said, "I **will** go to London".

He said that he **would** go to London.

She said, "I **will** wear a new dress".

She said that she **would** wear a new dress.

They said, "We **will** celebrate the birthday of our son".

They said that they **would** celebrate the birthday of their son.

You said that you **would not** waste your time.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE SIMPLE: will changes into would be

He said, "I **will** buy a camera".

He said that he **would** buy a camera.

He said, "I **will** go to London".

He said that he **would** go to London.

She said, "I **will** wear a new dress".

She said that she **would** wear a new dress.

They said, "We **will** celebrate the birthday of our son".

They said that they **would** celebrate the birthday of their son.

You said, "I **will not** waste my time".

You said that you **would not** waste your time.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE CONTINUOUS: will be changes into would be

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE CONTINUOUS: will be changes into would be

He said to me, "I **will be** waiting for you".

He said to me that he **would be** waiting for me.

She said, "I **will be** cleaning the room.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE CONTINUOUS: will be changes into would be

He said to me, "I **will be** waiting for you".

He said to me that he **would be** waiting for me.

She said, "I **will be** cleaning the room.

She said that she **would be** cleaning the room.



Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE CONTINUOUS: will be changes into would be

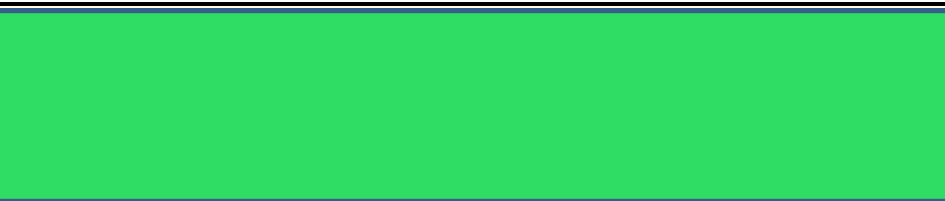
He said to me, "I **will be** waiting for you".

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She said, "I **will be** cleaning the room.

She said that she **would be** cleaning the room.

The kids said, "We **will be** playing with toys".



Rules for change of tenses

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The kids said, "We **will be** playing with toys".

The kids said that they **would be** playing with toys.

He said that the patient **would not be** feeling well.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

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She said that she **would be** cleaning the room.

The kids said, "We **will be** playing with toys".

The kids said that they **would be** playing with toys.

He said, "The patient **will not be** feeling well".

He said that the patient **would not be** feeling well.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE PERFECT: will have changes into would have

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE PERFECT: will have changes into would have

He said, "I will have started a new job.

He said that he would have started a new job.

She said, "I will have cooked some food".

She said that she would have cooked some food.

They said, "We will have succeeded in our mission".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

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They said that they would have succeeded in their mission.

He said, "David will have spoken the truth".

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Direct Speech

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They said that they **would have** succeeded in their mission.

He said, "David **will have** spoken the truth".

He said that David **would have** spoken the truth.

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She said that she **would have** cooked some food.

They said, "We **will have** succeeded in our mission".

They said that they **would have** succeeded in their mission.

He said, "David **will have** spoken the truth".

He said that David **would have** spoken the truth.

They that they **would not have** finished the work.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE PERFECT: will have changes into would have

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They said, "We **will have** succeeded in our mission".

They said that they **would have** succeeded in their mission.

He said, "David **will have** spoken the truth".

He said that David **would have** spoken the truth.

They said, "We **will not have** finished the work.

They that they **would not have** finished the work.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS: will have been	changes into would have been

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS: will have been **changes into** would have been

He said, "David **will have been** living in America since 10th April".

He said that David **would have been** living in America since 10th April.

She said, "I **will have been** listening to the music since 9 AM.

She said that she **would have been** listening to the music since 9 AM.

They said, "We **will have been** going to college since Monday".

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

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Rules for change of tenses

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They said that they **would have been** going to college since Monday.

You said that you **would not have been** using your camera for seven days.

Rules for change of tenses

Direct Speech

Indirect Speech

FUTURE TENSE

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS: will have been **changes into** would have been

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She said that she **would have been** listening to the music since 9 AM.

They said, "We **will have been** going to college since Monday".

They said that they **would have been** going to college since Monday.

You said, "I **will not have been** using my camera for seven days".

You said that you **would not have been** using your camera for seven days.

Rule – 2 (a)

As a rule the **will** of the future is changed into **would**.

Direct: Tom said, “They **will** come.”

Indirect: Tom said that they **would** come.

Tom said they **would** come.

Rule – 2 (b)

As a rule the **shall** of the future is changed into **should**.

Direct: She said, “He **shall** do his homework.”

Indirect: She said that he **should** do his homework.

Rule – 2 (c)

As a rule the **can** of the future is changed into **could**.

Direct: I said, “She **can** stay here.”

Indirect: I said that she **could** stay there.

Rule – 2 (d)

As a rule the **may** of the future is changed into **might**.

Direct: You said, “Jane **may** call.”

Indirect: You said that Jane **might** call.

Rule – 2 (e)

As a rule **have/has to** is changed into **had to**.

Direct: He said, “John **has to** go.”

Indirect: He said that John **had to** go.

Rule – 2 (f)

Imperative is changed to
to-Infinitive

Direct: He said, “John, **get out!**”

Indirect: He ordered John **to get out.**

command

*‘Leave at once!’ they
ordered.*

*They ordered us **to leave**
at once.*

to-infinitive clause

Rule – 3 (a)

The tenses will not change if the statement is **still relevant** or if it is a **universal truth**. *We can often choose whether to keep the original tenses or change them.*

Direct: “My birthday is on 6 September,” said John.

Indirect: John said that his birthday is/was on 6 September.

Rule – 3 (a)

The tenses will not change if the statement is still relevant or if it is a universal truth. We can often choose whether to keep the original tenses or change them.

Direct: The teacher **said**, "The earth **goes** round the sun."

Indirect: The teacher **said** that the earth **goes/went** round the sun.

Rule – 3 (b) Beware!

The tenses will not change if the statement is still relevant or if it is a universal truth. We can often choose whether to keep the original tenses or change them.

The past tense is often used when it is uncertain if the statement is true or when we are reporting objectively.

Rule – 3 (b)

The tenses will not change if the statement is **still relevant** or if it is a **universal truth**. *We can often choose whether to keep the original tenses or change them.*

Direct: “I know her address,” said John.

Indirect: John said that he knows/knew her address.

Rule – 3 (b)

The tenses will not change if the statement is still relevant or if it is a universal truth. We can often choose whether to keep the original tenses or change them.

Direct: She **said**, “German **is** easy to learn.”

Indirect: She **said** that German **was/is** easy to learn.

Rule – 4

The **PRONOUNS** of the Direct Speech are changed where necessary, so that their relations with the reporter and his hearer, rather than with the original speaker are indicated.

Direct: He said to **me**, “I do not believe **you**.”

Indirect: He said that **he** did not believe **me**.

Rule – 4

The pronouns of the Direct Speech are changed where necessary, so that their relations with the reporter and his hearer, rather than with the original speaker are indicated.

Direct: I said to **him**, “I did not believe **you**.”

Indirect: I said to **him** that I did not believe him / had not believed him.

Rule – 4

The pronouns of the Direct Speech are changed where necessary, so that their relations with the reporter and his hearer, rather than with the original speaker are indicated.

Direct: She said to him, “I do not believe you.”

Indirect: She told him that she did not believe him.

Rule – 4

The pronouns of the Direct Speech are changed where necessary, so that their relations with the reporter and his hearer, rather than with the original speaker are indicated.

Direct: I said to **you**, “I do not believe **you**.”

Indirect: I told **you** that I did not believe **you**.

Rule – 5

Words expressing **nearness in time or place** are generally **changed into** words expressing **distance**.

Direct: He said, “I am glad to be **here** this evening.”

Indirect: He said that he was glad to be **there** that evening.

Now - then

Here - there

Ago - before

Thus - so

Today - that day

Tomorrow - the next day

Yesterday - the day before

Last night - the night before

This - that

These - those

Rule – 5

Words expressing **nearness in time or place** are generally **changed into** words expressing **distance**.

Direct: He said, "I was here yesterday."

Indirect: He said that he was/had been there the day before.

Indirect Speech for Imperative Sentence:

A sentence that expresses a request, advice, or order is called an imperative sentence.

- Please help me. (request)
- Respect the elders. (advice)
- Open the door. (order)

Indirect Speech for Imperative Sentence:

- The imperative sentence expresses a request, advice or order. Therefore, to convert them into indirect speech, some specific verbs (e.g., **requested, advised, ordered, forbade, suggested**) are used instead of the reporting verbs (e.g., he said, she told).
- The word '**to**' or '**not to**' is also added before the verb of the reported speech within the sentence. See the following examples.

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Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
She said to me, "Please help me".	She requested me to help her.
He said to me, "Please make some tea for me".	He requested me to make some tea for him.
She said to them, "Please do not make a noise".	

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The old man said to him, "Always speak the truth".	

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	The teacher advised him not to waste his time.

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The doctor said to him, "Avoid unhealthy foods".	The doctor advised him to avoid unhealthy foods.
The doctor said to him, "Do not smoke".	The doctor advised him not to smoke.
The police said to the man, "Open the door".	The police ordered the man to open the door.
He said to me, "Close the window".	
	out of the room.

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	He ordered his servant to clean the room.

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Indirect Speech for Exclamatory Sentence:

A sentence that expresses a state of sorrow, joy or wonder, is known as exclamatory sentence.

- Hurrah! I won the competition. (state of joy)
- Alas! I failed my exam. (state of sorrow)
- Wow! What a beautiful car. (state of wonder)

Indirect Speech for Exclamatory Sentence:

A sentence that expresses a state of sorrow, joy or wonder, is known as exclamatory sentence.

The exclamatory sentence expresses state of joy, sorrow or wonder. Therefore, to convert them into indirect speech, some specific words (e.g., **exclaimed with joy**, **exclaimed with sorrow**, **exclaimed with wonder**) are used as the reporting verb. The usage of these words depends on the state of emotion expressed in the exclamatory sentence.

The exclamatory sentence expresses state of joy, sorrow or wonder. Therefore, to convert them into indirect speech, some specific words (e.g., **exclaimed with joy**, **exclaimed with sorrow**, **exclaimed with wonder**) are used as the reporting verb. The

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
They said, "Hurrah! We won the game".	They exclaimed with joy that they had won the game.
She said, "Hurrah! I passed the exam".	
He said, "Alas! I failed the exam".	He exclaimed with sorrow that he had failed the exam.
She said, "Oh! I lost my purse."	

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She said, "Oh! I lost my purse."	She exclaimed with sorrow that she had lost her purse.
	He exclaimed with sorrow that his brother had died in a car accident.

The exclamatory sentence expresses state of joy, sorrow or wonder. Therefore, to convert them into indirect speech, some specific words (e.g., **exclaimed with joy**, **exclaimed with sorrow**, **exclaimed with wonder**) are used as the reporting verb. The

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She said, "Oh! I lost my purse."	She exclaimed with sorrow that she had lost her purse.
He said, "Alas! My brother died in a car accident".	He exclaimed with sorrow that his brother had died in a car accident.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

She said to me, “Are you well?”

She asked me if I was well.

1. Inverted commas are removed in indirect speech.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

She said to me, “Are you well?”

She asked me if I was well.

2. The conjunction ‘that’ is not used in indirect speech for question sentences. The conjunction ‘that’ is generally used in indirect speech for other types of sentences but is not used in indirect speech for question sentences.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

She said to me, “Are you well?”

She asked me if I was well.

3. In indirect speech, the question sentence is expressed in positive (or assertive) form rather than question form.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

She said to me, “Are you well?”

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4. Since the question sentence is expressed as positive sentence, question mark (?) is not used in indirect speech for question sentence.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

She said to me, “Are you well?”

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5. The question sentence in direct speech may start with reporting verb such as ‘say’ or ‘tell’ (e.g., he said, she told). It is better to use verbs such as ‘ask’ or ‘inquire’ instead of ‘say’ or ‘tell’ (e.g., he asked, she asked) for making indirect speech of question sentence.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

She said to me, “Are you well?”

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6. The rules for changing the tense in indirect speech are similar for all types of sentences (e.g., positive, negative and interrogative sentences).

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

There are two types of questions

1. Questions which can be answered with YES or NO.
2. Questions which cannot be answered only with YES or NO but requires an answer in the form of a few words or a sentence.

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Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

1. Questions which can be answered with YES or NO

- Mostly starts with an Auxiliary

1. **Do** you live here?
2. **Will** you give me an answer?
3. **Have** you finished the job?

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

1. Questions which **cannot** be answered with YES or NO
 - Mostly starts with H/Wh question words

1. **How** are you?
2. **What** is your name?
3. **Where** do you live?

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

■ Questions that can be answered with “YES or NO”

To make indirect speech for such question sentences, the word ‘if’ or ‘whether’ is used before the reported speech (i.e., the question) within the sentence. Both of these words can be used interchangeably. It should be noted that question is always expressed in a positive form in indirect speech.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
He said to me, "Do you like coffee?"	He asked me if I liked coffee.
She said to me, "Do you play football?"	She asked me if I played football.
He said to me, "Will you help me?"	He asked me if I would help him.
David said to me, "Can I use your phone?"	David asked me if he could use my phone.
She said to me, "Did you see my cat?"	She asked me if I had seen her cat.
He said to me, "Are you enjoying the music?"	He asked me if I was enjoying the music.
She said to me, "Have you gone to London?"	She asked me if I had gone to London.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

■ Questions that cannot be answered with only “YES or NO”

The words ‘if’ or ‘whether’ is not used indirect speech for such question sentences. The question is only converted into positive (assertive) form and simply placed after the reporting verb.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
He said to me, "What are you doing?"	He asked me what I was doing.
She said to me, "What is your name?"	She asked me what my name was.
David said to me, "How are you?"	David asked me how I was.
He said to me, "Where are you going?"	He asked me where I was going.
She said to me, "What are you eating?"	She asked me what I was eating.
He said to me, "Why did you break the cup?"	He asked me why I had broken the cup.
John asked me, "When will you buy a camera?"	John asked me when I would buy a camera.
He said to me, "When will you come?"	He asked me when I would come.

Indirect Speech for question sentences - Rules

John said to me, "Will you buy a camera?"	John asked me if I would buy a camera.
He said to me, "Are you waiting for me".	He said to me if I was waiting for him.
She said to me, "Were you driving a car?"	She asked me if I had been driving a car.
She said to the patient, "Are you feeling well?"	She asked the patient whether he was feeling well.
John said to me, "Have you eaten some food?"	John asked me whether I had eaten some food.
He said to me, "Have you won a prize?"	He asked me whether I had won a prize.
She said to me, "Is it raining?"	She asked me whether it was raining.
He said to me, "Do you need any help?".	He asked me whether I needed any help.

How to change Direct to Indirect Speech?

Direct: John said, "I am very busy now."

Indirect: John said that he was very busy then.

Note the Changes

Direct: John said, "I am very busy now."

Indirect: John said that he was very busy then.

In Direct Speech, we use inverted commas to mark off the exact words of the speaker.

In Indirect Speech we do not use the inverted commas.

Note the Changes

Direct: John said, "I am very busy now."

Indirect: John said **that** he was very busy then.

We have used the conjunction **'that'** before the Indirect Statement.

Note the Changes

Direct: John said, “**I** am very busy now.”

Indirect: John said **that he** was very busy then.

The pronoun “**I**” is changed to “**HE**”. (The Pronoun is changed in Person)

Note the Changes

Direct: John said, **"I am** very busy **now."**

Indirect: John said **that he was** very busy then.

The verb **"am"** is changed to **"was"**.

Note the Changes

Direct: John said, “**I am** very busy **now**.”

Indirect: John said **that he was** very busy **then**.

The adverb “**now**” is changed to “**then**”.

Rule - 1

When the reporting or principal verb is in the Past Tense, all the **Present Tenses** in the **Direct Speech** are changed into **Past Tense**.

Direct: John **said**, "I **am** very busy now."

Indirect: John **said** that he **was** very busy then.

Rule - 1a

A simple present tense becomes simple past tense.

Direct : He said, "I am unwell."

Indirect: He said that he was unwell.

Rule - 1b

A **present continuous** tense becomes a **past continuous**.

Direct: He said, "My mother **is** writing a letter."

Indirect: He said that his mother **was** writing a letter.

Rule - 1c

A **present perfect** becomes a **past perfect**

Direct: He said, "I **have passed** the examination."

Indirect: He said that he **had passed** the examination.

Rule – 1d

As a rule the **simple past tense** in the Direct Speech becomes the **past perfect tense** in Indirect Speech.

Direct: He said, "His horse **died** in the night."

Indirect: He said that his horse **had died** in the night.

Rule – 3

If the reporting verb is in present tense, the tenses of the Direct Speech do not change.

Direct: He **says**, “I **am** unwell.”

Indirect: He **says** that he **is** unwell.

Rule – 3

If the reporting verb is in present tense, the tenses of the Direct Speech do not change.

Direct: He **says**, “My mother **is** writing a letter.”

Indirect: He **says** that his mother **is** writing a letter.

Rule – 3

If the reporting verb is in present tense, the tenses of the Direct Speech do not change.

Direct: He **says**, “I **have** passed the examination.”

Indirect: He **says** that he **has** passed the examination.

Rule – 3

If the reporting verb is in present tense, the tenses of the Direct Speech do not change.

Direct: He **says**, “His horse **died** in the night.”

Indirect: He **says** that his horse **died** in the night.

Changes in Tense

Direct Speech		Indirect Speech
Present Simple	↔	Past Simple
Present Continuous	↔	Past Continuous
Past Simple	↔	Past Perfect
Present Perfect	↔	Past Perfect
Will Future	↔	Would + Bare Infinitive
Can	↔	Could
Have To	↔	Had To
Imperative	↔	To Infinitive